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Own your e-mail

Owning your mail server simplifies the chaos that is mail management for small businesses, not to mention make you look more professional. We tested eight of them to see how far they can go towards helping you and your organisation get that business look!

People with small businesses may not have favourable views on the law, but they certainly love order. However, more often than not, one of the most important aspects of business—networking and managing contacts—is ignored, when a simple e-mail solution could work wonders for your business. After all, a free uncustomised e-mail ID is not only boring, it also does not send positive signals to clients.

Perhaps it's time for an e-mail server to bring order and method to the messages flowing in and out of your organisation, as well as those circulating internally. Adding to that, the e-mail ID will have your company's name attached to it, and approaching new clients and retaining old ones becomes much simpler than before.

The biggest advantage of an e-mail server is that the server goes online at specified intervals, and you need not have it connected to the Internet all day. This saves valuable Internet time, and therefore, money.

We take you through eight such solutions to help you decide what's best for your organisation.

CommuniGate Pro

Highly shielded

A brief dilemma awaits after you smoothly install CommuniGate Pro—you don't know how to configure the server since there are no entries made in the Start menu, while the documentation states that the admin interface runs on port 8010.

Getting to know the username and password for the admin interface is a bit troublesome. You have to browse through the documentation for a file named account.settings. By default, the 'postmaster' account acts as the administrator account. You need to enter the administrator password for each and every module, which can be irritating.

CommuniGate Pro supports flow control, i.e., it restricts a user to a maximum number of messages that he or she can send and receive in a pre-determined time. These are user-defined values.

It lacks a remote dialler, and features such as auto-archiving and auto-carbon copying. It also cannot assign user-priority and restrict